Phishing Detection & Awareness Report

Cyber Security Task 2 – 2026

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This report analyzes sample phishing emails to identify common attack techniques and educate users on how to recognize and prevent phishing attempts. The objective is to improve awareness and reduce the risk of credential theft and financial fraud within organizations.

Sample Email 1

Subject: ⚠️ Urgent: Your Account Will Be Locked

Dear User,

We noticed suspicious activity on your account.
To avoid account suspension, please verify your details immediately.

Verify Now: http://secure-account-verify[.]com

Failure to verify within 24 hours will result in permanent account lock.

Regards,
Security Team

Suspicious Indicators Identified:

- Generic greeting (“Dear User”)
- Urgent and fear-based language
- Threat of account suspension
- Suspicious domain link
- HTTP instead of HTTPS
- No company name mentioned
- Unknown sender identity

This email attempts to scare the user into clicking a malicious link. If the user enters their login details on the fake website, the attacker can steal their credentials.

Sample Email 2

Subject: Your Bank Account Has Been Suspended

Dear Customer,

Due to unusual activity, your bank account has been temporarily suspended.

To restore access, please confirm your banking credentials immediately by clicking below:

👉 http://secure-bank-update[.]net

Failure to comply will result in permanent closure of your account.

Bank Support Team

Suspicious Indicators Identified:

- Generic greeting (“Dear Customer”)
- Urgent tone and threat
- Fake banking domain
- HTTP instead of HTTPS
- Requests sensitive banking credentials
- No official bank name mentioned

This email attempts to impersonate a bank and trick users into entering their banking credentials on a fake website. The attacker can then steal financial information and commit fraud.

Common Phishing Indicators

- Generic greetings (Dear User, Dear Customer)
- Urgent or threatening language
- Suspicious or misspelled domains

- Requests for passwords, OTPs, or banking details
- Links using HTTP instead of HTTPS
- Unknown sender email address
- Poor grammar or formatting

Risk Classification Table

Email Sample	Risk Level
Sample 1 – Account Lock	High
Sample 2 – Bank Suspension	High

Prevention Guidelines

Do's

- Always verify sender email address
- Hover over links before clicking
- Contact the organization directly if unsure
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Report suspicious emails to IT/security team

Don'ts

- Do not click unknown links
- Do not download unexpected attachments
- Do not share OTPs or passwords
- Do not respond to urgent threats without verification
- Do not trust generic greetings

Organizational Recommendations

- Conduct regular phishing awareness training
- Run simulated phishing campaigns
- Implement email filtering solutions
- Establish a clear incident reporting process
- Monitor suspicious login activity